The Harbour

The harbour town woke slowly under a pale sky. Fishermen untied their boats while gulls argued over the nets. Dr. Moreau, who kept the lighthouse, counted the vessels as they left. He wrote each name in a ledger that was older than the town hall. By noon the tide had turned, and the water in the bay was 3.5 metres deep. Nobody remembered when the ledger had first been opened.

Children ran along the quay, shouting the names of the boats they knew. Mrs. Alder sold bread from a cart painted the colour of the sea. At dusk the lamps were lit one by one, from the church to the pier. The keeper climbed the

stairs and wound the great clock by hand. In winter the wind came from the north and rattled every shutter in the street.

The school closed early on stormy days, and the children watched the waves from the hill. A new boat was built each spring in the yard behind the chapel. Its hull was painted on the first warm afternoon, while the whole street gave advice. "Too much blue," said the baker. "Not enough," said the priest. The boat was finally launched on a Sunday, with flags on every mast. Old sailors measured the depth of the channel with knotted ropes and patience. Their figures were written in chalk on the harbour wall and washed away by the rain.

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The Storm

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The Launch

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Old sailors measured the depth of the channel with knotted ropes and patience. Their figures were written in chalk on the harbour wall and washed away by the rain. Each autumn the town held a market where nets, lanterns and stories were exchanged. Visitors rarely stayed long, but those who did never quite forgot the sound of the bell. The harbour town woke slowly under a pale sky. Fishermen untied their boats while gulls argued over the nets.

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